

The reconstruction of reading order from a page description language is necessarily an inference, since the file records only where ink is placed and never what any of it means to a reader who encounters it in sequence. Justified setting widens the interword spaces on every line but the last, which is precisely the signal a naive column detector reads as structure rather than as typography.

A second paragraph exists so that the page has a paragraph boundary to find. The leading between these two paragraphs is whatever the stylesheet says it is, which is the point: a threshold tuned to a generator that leaves a full blank line between paragraphs will not fire here, and the failure is silent.

A third paragraph makes the run long enough that a missed boundary costs real tokens. Every line in this block is hard-wrapped by the typesetter, and joining them back into one line per paragraph is most of what cleaning a PDF is for.